SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

16 October 2020 · Shift 1

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 52 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. While the most common belief is that these traits remain fixed, research studies show otherwise! B. One such research study suggests that we can change our traits provided we want to change them. C. We all possess certain personality traits that set us apart from the rest. D. These traits, a mix of good and bad, define how we respond to situations and people.

(A) ACDB
(B) CBDA
(C) CDAB
(D) BCAD

Q.2

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. One whom it is impossible to defeat

(A) Dissatisfied
(B) Cowardly
(C) Invincible
(D) Inimitable

Q.3

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The manager said, “I want you to attend the conference.”

(A) The manager said that she wanted me to attend the conference.
(B) The manager said that she want me to attend the conference.
(C) The manager told to me I am to go to attend the conference.
(D) The manager said I am wanting you to attend the conference.

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Immediate
(B) Amass
(C) Messanger
(D) Massage

Q.5

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Red okra from Karnataka. Black rice from Gujarat. Red corn from Tamil Nadu. What you would (1)_____ as exotic varieties of food today are (2)_____ indigenous crops that belong to a specific region. Many such (3)_____ crops have gone extinct. Many more are on the brink. But with Indian households (4)_____ more conscious about healthy eating and the natural benefits of consuming local food, (5)_____ among both consumers and farmers is increasing.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 1.

(A) describing
(B) describes
(C) describe
(D) described

Q.6

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Red okra from Karnataka. Black rice from Gujarat. Red corn from Tamil Nadu. What you would (1)_____ as exotic varieties of food today are (2)_____ indigenous crops that belong to a specific region. Many such (3)_____ crops have gone extinct. Many more are on the brink. But with Indian households (4)_____ more conscious about healthy eating and the natural benefits of consuming local food, (5)_____ among both consumers and farmers is increasing.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 2.

(A) mostly
(B) surprisingly
(C) incredibly
(D) openly

Q.7

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Red okra from Karnataka. Black rice from Gujarat. Red corn from Tamil Nadu. What you would (1)_____ as exotic varieties of food today are (2)_____ indigenous crops that belong to a specific region. Many such (3)_____ crops have gone extinct. Many more are on the brink. But with Indian households (4)_____ more conscious about healthy eating and the natural benefits of consuming local food, (5)_____ among both consumers and farmers is increasing.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 3.

(A) native
(B) global
(C) foreign
(D) new

Q.8

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Red okra from Karnataka. Black rice from Gujarat. Red corn from Tamil Nadu. What you would (1)_____ as exotic varieties of food today are (2)_____ indigenous crops that belong to a specific region. Many such (3)_____ crops have gone extinct. Many more are on the brink. But with Indian households (4)_____ more conscious about healthy eating and the natural benefits of consuming local food, (5)_____ among both consumers and farmers is increasing.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 4.

(A) becomes
(B) have become
(C) became
(D) becoming

Q.9

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Red okra from Karnataka. Black rice from Gujarat. Red corn from Tamil Nadu. What you would (1)_____ as exotic varieties of food today are (2)_____ indigenous crops that belong to a specific region. Many such (3)_____ crops have gone extinct. Many more are on the brink. But with Indian households (4)_____ more conscious about healthy eating and the natural benefits of consuming local food, (5)_____ among both consumers and farmers is increasing.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 5.

(A) awareness
(B) intelligence
(C) apprehension
(D) experience

Q.10

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. You've cleared the _____ examination, haven't you?

(A) frequent
(B) ability
(C) conclusion
(D) entrance

Q.11

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. A Delhi bound aircraft has to make an emergency landing at Mumbai airport as a woman passenger suddenly developed a serious breathing problem.

(A) suddenly developed
(B) as a woman passenger
(C) has to make
(D) a serious breathing problem

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. My doctor knew that I would eventually recover and do the kind of work I "would be doing" before.

(A) had been doing
(B) would have been doing
(C) would have done
(D) No improvement

Q.13

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. My friend narrated a very interesting story at the International Storytelling Festival.

(A) A very interesting story was being narrated by my friend at the International Storytelling Festival.
(B) A very interesting story has been narrated by my friend at the International Storytelling Festival.
(C) A very interesting story was narrated by my friend at the International Storytelling Festival.
(D) A very interesting story is being narrated by my friend at the International Storytelling Festival.

Q.14

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The student has made a _____ to the police about a false video of her that is being circulated by some miscreants.

(A) complaint
(B) complain
(C) complainant
(D) complaining

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. The teacher said that all "that" students who did not complete the task in the given time should attempt it again.

(A) No improvement
(B) those
(C) this
(D) them

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Let off the hook

(A) Not made to wait for a long time
(B) Not allowed to take part in an activity
(C) Allowed to escape from blame
(D) Made to pay for one's actions

Q.18

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. According to environment activitists, demolition of unauthorised apartment complexes are became a lesson for land encroachers.

(A) demolition of unauthorised apartment complexes
(B) are became
(C) for land encroachers
(D) According to

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Parthian shot

(A) Parting hit
(B) Victory
(C) Praise
(D) Say goodbye

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. DEROGATORY

(A) Favourable
(B) Appreciative
(C) Sarcastic
(D) Lethargic

Q.21

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Vijay the bus conductor was always there in one of these trucks. B. He had now quit his old job and joined politics. C. In the week before the elections, trucks bumped up and down the dirty streets of Laxmangarh, full of young men holding microphones and shouting: “Stand up to the rich!” D. That was the thing about Vijay; each time you saw him, he had done better for himself.

(A) CABD
(B) CBAD
(C) ABCD
(D) DABC

Q.22

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. INCOHERENT

(A) Intelligible
(B) Puzzling
(C) Delightful
(D) Inconsistent

Q.23

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Soon passing out or of a short duration

(A) Frostbite
(B) Evanescent
(C) Extempore
(D) Fluke

Q.24

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. OPTIONAL

(A) Elective
(B) Fanciful
(C) Original
(D) Compulsory

Q.25

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. DEPLETE

(A) Reduce
(B) Complete
(C) Raise
(D) Increase

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

The last Mauryan ruler to be killed by Pushyamitra Shunga was:

(A) Brihadratha
(B) Dasharatha
(C) Bindusara
(D) Devavarman

Q.2

Who is the 47th Chief Justice of India?

(A) Sharad Arvind Bobde
(B) NV Ramana
(C) Ranjan Gogoi
(D) Dipak Misra

Q.3

How many gold medals did India win at the '1986 Asian Games' held in Seoul, South Korea?

(A) 9
(B) 5
(C) 6
(D) 8

Q.4

In which year was the Bharat Ratna award instituted?

(A) 1956
(B) 1950
(C) 1954
(D) 1953

Q.5

When was the Indian national song 'Vande Mataram' sung for the first time on a political occasion?

(A) 1896 INC session
(B) 1900 INC session
(C) 1903 INC session
(D) 1911 INC session

Q.6

Which is the second most abundant gas in Earth's atmosphere?

(A) Oxygen
(B) Nitrogen
(C) Hydrogen
(D) Carbon di oxide

Q.7

In which medium does sound travel faster?

(A) Gas
(B) Liquid
(C) Solid
(D) Vacuum

Q.8

Batholith is a type of:

(A) secondary pollutant
(B) valley
(C) ocean current
(D) igneous rock

Q.9

With which of the following sports is Manika Batra associated?

(A) Badminton
(B) Cricket
(C) Table Tennis
(D) Gymnastics

Q.10

The GST council is headed by the:

(A) Prime minister
(B) SEBI chairman
(C) RBI governor
(D) Union finance minister

Q.11

The _____ is responsible for Earth's magnetic field.

(A) inner core
(B) mantle
(C) outer core
(D) crust

Q.12

Who is the author of the book 'The Blue Umbrella'?

(A) Suketu Mehta
(B) Ruskin Bond
(C) Vikram Seth
(D) Vikram Chandra

Q.13

A higher _____ index represents inequality in income distribution.

(A) CPI
(B) Gini
(C) GDP
(D) NDP

Q.14

'Disha Act' was passed by which of the following state in December 2019?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Telangana
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.15

Rambir Singh Khokar received the ‘Dronacharya award’ for:

(A) Wrestling
(B) Athletics
(C) Kabaddi
(D) Football

Q.16

Which of the following is NOT an e-commerce website?

(A) Uber
(B) Swiggy
(C) Flipkart
(D) Google Maps

Q.17

International Astronomical Union (IAU) named minor planet 2006 VP32 (number -300128) in September 2019 after a famous Indian. Who is this Indian?

(A) APJ Abdul Kalam
(B) Pandit Jasraj
(C) Hamsa Padmanabhan
(D) Viswanathan Anand

Q.18

In which part of a plant are mesophyll cells found?

(A) Seed
(B) Leaf
(C) Stem
(D) Root

Q.19

_____ is a diagrammatic representation of a program logic.

(A) Process
(B) Flowchart
(C) Data
(D) Legend

Q.20

The Constitution under Article _____ mandates the Election Commission, to conduct elections to the Parliament and the State Legislatures.

(A) 312
(B) 324
(C) 330
(D) 298

Q.21

Which river is also called 'Dihang' in India?

(A) Brahmaputra
(B) Indus
(C) Ganges
(D) Tapti

Q.23

Birthplace of Guru Nanak known as Nankana Sahib today, was earlier called.

(A) Roda
(B) Umarkot
(C) Rai Bhoi di Talvandi
(D) Luni

Q.24

A force due to which moving objects (wind and water current) tend to deflect to the right in Northern hemisphere and left in Southern hemisphere is known as:

(A) Coriolis force
(B) Endogenic force
(C) Magnetic force
(D) Applied force

Q.25

'Dhimsa' is a tribal dance form of which Indian state?

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (C) CDAB

C introduces personality traits, D says what these traits do, A brings in the common belief that they are fixed and the research that disagrees, and B gives one such study: CDAB.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Invincible

'Invincible' means too strong to be defeated. 'Inimitable' means impossible to imitate, and 'dissatisfied' and 'cowardly' do not fit.

Q.3 · Answer (A) The manager said that she wanted me to attend the conference.

In reported speech 'I' becomes 'she' and 'you' becomes 'me', and after 'said' the present 'want' moves back to the past 'wanted'. The other options keep the present tense or are ungrammatical.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Messanger

The correct spelling is 'messenger'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) describe

'Would' is followed by the bare infinitive: 'What you would describe as exotic varieties of food'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) mostly

'Mostly' makes the generalisation: most of these so-called exotic foods are in fact indigenous crops of particular regions. 'Indigenous' is not a matter of degree, so 'incredibly' and 'surprisingly' cannot qualify it, and 'openly' makes no sense here.

Q.7 · Answer (A) native

'Native' crops are those that belong to a region, the indigenous crops of the previous sentence; 'global', 'foreign' and 'new' contradict that.

Q.8 · Answer (D) becoming

After 'with' and a noun, the -ing form describes what is happening: 'with Indian households becoming more conscious'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) awareness

As households grow more conscious of healthy eating and local food, 'awareness' among consumers and farmers increases.

Q.10 · Answer (D) entrance

An 'entrance examination' is the test taken for admission to a course or institution, the kind one 'clears'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) has to make

The landing happened in the past, as 'developed' shows, so the verb must be 'had to make', not 'has to make'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) had been doing

The work went on up to a time in the past, so the past perfect continuous is needed: 'the kind of work I had been doing before'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) A very interesting story was narrated by my friend at the International Storytelling Festival.

The simple past 'narrated' becomes 'was narrated' in the passive: 'A very interesting story was narrated by my friend'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) complaint

After the article 'a' a noun is needed: one makes 'a complaint'. 'Complain' is the verb, and a 'complainant' is the person who complains.

Q.15 · Answer (B) those

'Students' is plural, so the demonstrative must be plural too: 'all those students who did not complete the task'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Allowed to escape from blame
To 'let someone off the hook' is to free them from blame, punishment or a duty.

Q.18 · Answer (B) are became
'Are became' is not a verb form, and the subject 'demolition' is singular: 'demolition of unauthorised apartment complexes has become a lesson'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Parting hit
A 'Parthian shot' is a sharp remark or blow delivered while leaving, after the Parthian horsemen who shot arrows back as they rode away: a parting hit.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Sarcastic
SSC's key gives 'sarcastic', the only option close in sense: 'derogatory' means disparaging or belittling, and 'sarcastic' means mocking or scornful. 'Favourable' and 'appreciative' are opposites of 'derogatory', and 'lethargic' means sluggish.

Q.21 · Answer (A) CABD
C sets the scene of trucks full of young men before the elections, A places Vijay in one of these trucks, B says he had quit his job for politics, and D remarks that he always did better for himself: CABD.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Intelligible
'Incoherent' means unclear and hard to follow; 'intelligible' means able to be understood.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Evanescent
'Evanescent' means soon passing out of sight or existence. 'Extempore' means unprepared, a 'fluke' is a lucky chance and 'frostbite' is injury from cold.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Compulsory
'Optional' means left to choice; 'compulsory' means required. 'Elective' is a synonym.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Reduce
To 'deplete' is to use up or reduce. 'Raise' and 'increase' are its opposites.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Brihadratha
Pushyamitra Shunga, the army commander, killed Brihadratha, the last Mauryan king, in about 185 BCE and founded the Shunga dynasty.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Sharad Arvind Bobde
Sharad Arvind Bobde became the 47th Chief Justice of India on 18 November 2019, succeeding Ranjan Gogoi, and held the office when the exam was held (October 2020); N V Ramana succeeded him in April 2021.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 5
India won 5 gold medals at the 1986 Asian Games in Seoul, with 9 silver and 23 bronze; P T Usha won four of the golds in athletics.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 1954
The Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian award, was instituted on 2 January 1954.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 1896 INC session
Rabindranath Tagore sang 'Vande Mataram' at the 1896 Calcutta session of the Indian National Congress, its first singing at a political gathering.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Oxygen
Dry air is about 78% nitrogen and 21% oxygen by volume; argon and carbon dioxide make up most of the rest.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Solid
Sound is carried by vibrating particles, which are most closely packed and most stiffly bound in solids, so it travels fastest there; it cannot travel through a vacuum at all.

Q.8 · Answer (D) igneous rock
A batholith is a large mass of intrusive igneous rock, such as granite, formed when magma cools and solidifies deep within the crust.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Table Tennis
Manika Batra is an Indian table tennis player; she won the women's singles gold at the 2018 Commonwealth Games.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Union finance minister
Under Article 279A the Union Finance Minister chairs the GST Council; the Union Minister of State in charge of Revenue or Finance and a minister nominated by each state (usually its finance minister) are its members.

Q.11 · Answer (C) outer core
Currents in the molten iron of the liquid outer core, driven by convection and Earth's rotation, generate the magnetic field. The inner core is solid.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Ruskin Bond
'The Blue Umbrella', the story of Binya, a village girl in the Garhwal hills, and her prized umbrella, is by Ruskin Bond.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Gini
The Gini index runs from 0, perfect equality, to 1 (or 100), where one person has all the income, so a higher value means a more unequal distribution. CPI measures prices, and GDP and NDP output.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Andhra Pradesh
In December 2019 the Andhra Pradesh Assembly passed the Disha Bill, which sets short deadlines for investigating and trying sexual offences against women and children. It is named after the Hyderabad veterinarian raped and murdered in November 2019.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Kabaddi
Rambir Singh Khokhar, a kabaddi coach, received the Dronacharya Award in the lifetime category in 2019.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Google Maps
Google Maps is a mapping and navigation service; nothing is bought or sold on it. Flipkart sells goods online, and Uber and Swiggy take orders and payments online for rides and food delivery.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Pandit Jasraj
Minor planet 300128 (2006 VP32), found in 2006 by the Mount Lemmon Survey, was named 'Panditjasraj' in 2019 after the Hindustani classical vocalist Pandit Jasraj.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Leaf
Mesophyll is the tissue between the upper and lower epidermis of a leaf; its palisade and spongy cells, rich in chloroplasts, carry out most of the plant's photosynthesis.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Flowchart
A flowchart shows the steps and decisions of a program or process as boxes of standard shapes joined by arrows.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 324
Article 324 vests the superintendence, direction and control of elections to Parliament, the State Legislatures and the offices of President and Vice-President in the Election Commission.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Brahmaputra
In Arunachal Pradesh the Brahmaputra is called the Siang or Dihang; in Tibet it is the Tsangpo.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Rai Bhoi di Talvandi
Guru Nanak was born in 1469 at Rai Bhoi di Talwandi, a village later renamed Nankana Sahib after him; it is now in Pakistan's Punjab.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Coriolis force

The Coriolis force, which arises from Earth's rotation, deflects moving air and water to the right in the Northern Hemisphere and to the left in the Southern.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Andhra Pradesh

Dhimsa is a group dance of the tribal communities of the Araku Valley and nearby hills of Andhra Pradesh (in Visakhapatnam district when the exam was held, October 2020, and in Alluri Sitharama Raju district since 2022); it is also danced in southern Odisha.

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